Johannes **Nguyen**

IT Specialist for System Integration · DKFZ Heidelberg

johannes.nguyen@j551n.com j551n.com j551n-ncloud johannesquangminh

Profile

Linux sysadmin in the ODCF team at the German Cancer Research Center (DKFZ), qualified as IT Specialist for System Integration (IHK) in 07/2026. Daily work: datacenter operations, service deployment with Ansible, IBM ESS storage and HPC cluster troubleshooting. Trained automotive mechatronics technician (Mercedes-Benz), with the habit of fixing the cause of a fault, not the symptom.

Experience

German Cancer Research Center (DKFZ)

Heidelberg, DE

IT Specialist for System Integration (ODCF), apprentice until 07/2026 — *2022 – present*

- **Datacenter:** on-site maintenance of Dell PowerEdge servers via iDRAC, documented the cabling of 11 racks in **NetBox** for the network team, with self-built trace and report tools
- **Ansible:** deploy services with own roles, playbooks and deploy scripts, install hosts via Kickstart
- **Storage:** shares, quotas and permissions on **IBM ESS**, troubleshoot NFS issues on the cluster nodes
- **HPC cluster:** troubleshoot **IBM LSF** nodes and failed jobs for researchers across the DKFZ
- **Services:** run the department's Harbor registry, took AWX and Ascender from evaluation to k3s with LDAP/AD login, moved the module system to EasyBuild (GCC 14)
- **GxP validation:** set up Bitwarden with ADFS (SAML) login, first validation approved in 08/2026, now writing the full validation as **GAMP 5** category 4: risk analysis, requirements, IQ/OQ/PQ, traceability
- **Incident:** during a staff shortage took over two RStudio servers with several hundred users and fixed a licensing outage without prior experience on the system
- **Documentation:** more than 10 SOPs, including ESS shares and quotas, host deployment, TLS certificate rollout and LSF maintenance

Vögele

Ludwigshafen, DE

Commercial Vehicle Mechanic — *2021 – 2022*

BASF, Porsche, TRW, GRN

Various locations

Internships: computer science, prototyping, materials testing — *2013 – 2016*

Education

German Cancer Research Center (DKFZ)

Heidelberg, DE

IT Specialist for System Integration (IHK apprenticeship), completed 07/2026 — *2022 – 2026*

- **Final project:** set up a **Proxmox Backup Server** and integrated it into the department's Proxmox environment, including nodes without local storage: backup concept, LDAP login, firewalld hardening, Prometheus monitoring, LACP uplink, operations documentation
- **Rotations:** Service Center (automated client installation with WDS), IT department (Proxmox, Matrix42), then ODCF

Mercedes-Benz

Mannheim, DE

Automotive Mechatronics Technician (apprenticeship) — *2017 – 2021*

Projects

Per-user CPU and RAM limits

Work project, DKFZ

Ansible · systemd · PAM

- Ansible role that puts every user on shared cluster nodes into a systemd slice with fixed CPU and RAM limits, applied at login through PAM, in production

git-iac: GitOps for the homelab

github.com/j551n-ncloud

GitLab CI · Ansible · Harbor · Trivy

- One repo builds, scans and pushes the images, the other pins the versions, a merge takes a Proxmox snapshot and rolls out with Ansible: 15 Docker stacks on 5 hosts

Homelab

Personal project

Proxmox VE · PBS · k3s · Pangolin · Tailscale

- Three-node Proxmox cluster with around 15 services, backups via Proxmox Backup Server, k3s for CI runners and the LAN reverse proxy
- Public access through a Pangolin gateway with CrowdSec, SSH only via Tailscale, single sign-on via OIDC

Skills

System administration	Linux (RHEL, Debian, systemd, auditd), Windows Server, IBM LSF, IBM ESS, NFS, autofs, Dell iDRAC, HPE iLO
Automation	Ansible (own roles and playbooks), AWX, Kickstart, Bash, GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions
Containers & virtualization	Docker, Harbor, Kubernetes (k3s, Helm), Proxmox VE and Backup Server, VMware ESXi
Networking	VLANs, LACP, NetBox, Infoblox IPAM, Tailscale
Identity & security	LDAP/AD, SSSD, Kerberos, ADFS, OIDC, TLS/PKI, CrowdSec, Trivy
Monitoring	Grafana, Prometheus, Checkmk, Loki
Quality	GxP, GAMP 5, IQ/OQ/PQ, SOPs
Development	Python, SQL, TypeScript, Node.js, MCP servers